



PROGRESS REPORT

Public debate and participation in policymaking: progress report, 2025-08-01 to 2026-08-27

Edition of 2026-08-27 · compiled by Claude Opus from the documents in the Corpus repository

19 places. Every table below is carried verbatim from that place's own progress report; nothing is written here.

CHAD · ESWATINI · LESOTHO · MALI · MAURITIUS · MOROCCO · NAMIBIA · NIGER · NIGERIA · RWANDA · SAO TOME AND PRINCIPE · SENEGAL · SEYCHELLES · TANZANIA · TOGO · UGANDA · ZAMBIA · ZIMBABWE · WEST AFRICA

Movement values. *Advanced* — a system entered service, a stage was completed or an instrument was made. *Stalled* — a stated target passed without delivery. *Regressed* — an instrument was withdrawn or neutralised, or a measured position worsened. *Closed* — the programme ended. *No change* — the position at both ends is the same. *Baseline not held* — the base carries no position at the start of the period, so no movement can be stated. A value may carry a qualifying clause after a comma, as in *Advanced*, *slipped*.

The place reports do not share one window; the period above is the range they span.

Chad

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Suspension of applications to create online newspapers	Not held - the base carries no record of the media regulator before 2026-08-03	Examination suspended indefinitely, with no published criteria, no end date and no transitional treatment of applications already filed, so existing licensed online outlets are a closed list for the duration	REGRESSED, BASELINE NOT HELD
Internet shutdown in Lac province	Offline since 2024-10-28, with no restoration recorded	No restoration, extension or official justification on record, and the base carries nothing on it inside the window	NO CHANGE
Media regulator's three-year strategic plan for 2026-2028	Not held	In application, with the plan itself, its axes in full and its publication date not held	BASELINE NOT HELD

Eswatini

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Public account of the Google memorandum	Not on the record	Established after a public contradiction between the prime minister and the Attorney-General	ADVANCED

Lesotho

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Allegation of interference in regulator appointments	Did not exist	The outgoing chief licensing officer at the communications authority accused the government of political interference in the regulator's senior appointments, alleging at a media briefing reported on 22 August 2026 that the communications minister pressed the board to re-advertise his post rather than renew the five-year contract that expired on 31 May 2026, and that the universal service fund's executive secretary was removed in the same way; the minister said she has no role in recruiting the authority's managers, and the authority declined to comment	ADVANCED
Public digital services experience survey	BASELINE NOT HELD	Open to citizens, covering access, usability, trust and skills gaps across online applications, digital payments and health and education platforms, as part of a donor-backed digital readiness assessment	Baseline not held

Mali

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Speech prosecutions before the cybercrime pole	None on file	A newspaper editor sentenced to 12 months with six suspended for undermining the credibility of the state, having been arrested in June by the national cybercrime unit, in what a press-freedom body describes as authorities using cybercrime provisions to prosecute journalists	REGRESSED

Mauritius

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Mauritius Internet Governance Forum	Not held	Convening as a national multi-stakeholder forum founded by the Halley Movement; at its 2026 meeting the Blockchain for Good Alliance and the exchange Bybit met the Vice President and the ICT minister to discuss artificial intelligence, cybersecurity and digital-trust frameworks for small island developing states	BASELINE NOT HELD
Public argument on what digital investment is for	BASELINE NOT HELD	The clearest domestic objection on file to the artificial-intelligence-first framing: that contract enforcement rather than technology is the binding constraint, with digitalised case management prescribed alongside a small-claims process and a stronger commercial division rather than instead of them (2026-08)	Baseline not held

Morocco

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Ombudsman memorandum on administrative reform	Did not exist	The ombudsman issued a vigilance memorandum calling for reform of the administration and the civil service to be made a horizontal public policy under a single, clearly located government lead, with simplification, digitisation and deconcentration coordinated as one workstream rather than parallel ones, and proposing a national system for evaluating administrative performance built on indicators of service quality, ease of access, delivery times, user satisfaction and how far administrations respond to complaints and implement recommendations	ADVANCED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Law 55.19 on procedural simplification	BASELINE NOT HELD	In force, but the ombudsman's 2025 report finds agencies still asking for paper copies of documents already held electronically and imposing undisclosed extra conditions	<i>Baseline not held</i>
Public debate on platform regulation and digital sovereignty	Baseline not held	Specialists arguing for a law defining platform responsibilities and notice-and-response mechanisms, and against blanket blocking or breaking encryption (2026-08)	BASELINE NOT HELD

Namibia

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Published draft and consultation record of the Data Protection Bill	Did not exist	A dated consultation record: the ministry opened public input on the draft Data Protection Bill on 2022-10-26 with a closing date of 2022-11-30, addressed to two named ministry officers; the ACTION Namibia Coalition filed a submission on the closing date, compiled by ALT Advisory and funded by the Embassy of Finland through IPPR's Democracy Report project; IPPR published the same argument as a public paper on 2022-12-14, arguing the sections on the Supervisory Authority's independence need substantial redrafting and that offences and penalties provisions are undeveloped; no ministry-published list of respondents is held, and no further consultation activity is on record since	ADVANCED

Niger

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
PNDN 2026-2035 consultation and validation process	Did not exist	A redrafting committee installed 2025-07-18 revised the draft policy; a national validation workshop held 2026-03-11 was described by the ministry as the product of broad consultation among public- and private-sector digital-ecosystem actors; no separate open public-comment or civil-society submission channel is named	ADVANCED

Nigeria

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Demand to suspend enforcement of the Cybercrimes Act	Did not exist	A rights organisation and the Guild of Editors jointly called on 24 August 2026 for enforcement of the Act to be suspended pending repeal or revision, arguing that the 2024 amendment failed to cure the defect the ECOWAS Court of Justice identified in 2022 when it ruled the original section 24 vague, arbitrary and in breach of the African Charter; the amended text is said to keep ambiguous cyberstalking wording under which a prosecution can turn on someone claiming to feel fear, and the call cites extrajudicial arrests, malicious prosecutions, enforced disappearances and unlawful surveillance reaching as far as posts in private messaging groups	ADVANCED

Rwanda

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Internet governance forum	BASELINE NOT HELD	An annual multistakeholder forum run under the domain registry, with nearly 200 people through a school on internet governance and a youth forum	<i>Baseline not held</i>

Sao Tome and Principe

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
FGI STP (Forum de Governanca da Internet)	Did not exist	1st edition held, regulator (AGER)-convened; agenda covered digital trust, infrastructure, regulation, privacy/ data protection, AI, internet/social media; no outcome document or next-edition date published	ADVANCED

Senegal

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Social-media regulation workstream	BASELINE NOT HELD	Under way since 2024; no bill, decree or timetable named, and an observatory is a proposal	<i>Baseline not held</i>

Seychelles

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Appointment and dismissal power over the SBC board	Vested in the independent Constitutional Appointments Authority	Greater powers over the appointment and dismissal of the public broadcaster's board transferred to the President by a June 2026 amendment to the SBC Act	REGRESSED
Perceived media freedom	51% said the media was somewhat or completely free (2022)	45% say the media is somewhat or completely free and 52% say it is not very or not at all free (2025 survey), against 78% who want the media to investigate government mistakes and corruption and 85% who back the right to publish without government interference	REGRESSED

Tanzania

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Licensed online media	Six online content aggregators, 74 weblogs, 221 online television stations, 51 cable television operators and 10 online radio stations at March 2026	Five online content aggregators, 66 weblogs, 210 online television stations and 49 cable television operators at June 2026, with online radio the exception at 12; the regulator said the quarterly decline was not evidence of a shrinking digital economy, pointing to July 2026 changes to the online content regulations that cut licence fees by 90%, from TZS 1m to TZS 100,000 for aggregators and from TZS 500,000 to TZS 50,000 for ordinary online content providers	REGRESSED
Online gendered violence against election candidates	Baseline not held	Documented as cyclical across successive elections in a two-country civil-society study, with no state measurement held against it	BASELINE NOT HELD

Togo

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
National consumer-rights outreach tour	Not held	The regulator seventh national sensitisation tour, running 3 to 28 August 2026 with consumer associations and operators, briefing mobile operators and consumer-association leaders on electronic-communications rights and, at Bassar, on preventing mobile-money fraud; it reached consumer associations and opinion leaders in the Savanes prefectures in August, and at Kara local officials asked the regulator to widen its remit to all economic operators	BASELINE NOT HELD

Uganda

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Climate information integrity project	Did not exist	A project on climate-change disinformation and information integrity in African digital ecosystems, focused on Uganda and Ethiopia and supported by a UNESCO-led global initiative, combining research mapping how climate disinformation spreads and who drives it with a fact-checking masterclass at the 2026 internet-freedom forum, online training for journalists and civil society, and tracking of African governments' communications ahead of the November 2026 climate conference	ADVANCED
Fourth-cycle Universal Periodic Review	Third-cycle review concluded January 2022 with 273 recommendations, 139 supported and 134 noted; no fourth-cycle submission on file (2025-08)	Joint submission by CIPESA, APC and WOUGNET filed, seeking repeal of the Computer Misuse Act speech offences, a statutory bar on network disruption, removal of the 12% excise duty on internet data, and statutory independence and fining powers for the Personal Data Protection Office; the review had not been held as at 2026-08-07	ADVANCED
Judiciary media guidelines issued through ECCMIS	Did not exist (2025-08)	Prior accreditation required, devices barred from the courtroom, live broadcasting granted case by case; the Law Society asked for the restrictions to be lifted	ADVANCED
URA e-Tax2 award	Technical evaluation notice displayed 2025-08-25, under challenge	Award set aside by the Appeals Tribunal on a power-of-attorney defect, the capacity objection struck out unadjudicated; none of 26 commercial banks would issue the guarantee gating the 15% advance; joint-venture staff on the revenue authority's premises since January with no work started	STALLED

Zambia

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Public consultation on the Postal Services Act review	Baseline not held	The ministry invited any member of the public to submit proposals for amendment with justification, closing 2026-07-27, a window of three days from the call reported on 2026-07-24; no submission count, published responses or consultation report is held	CLOSED

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-26	MOVEMENT
Digital systems in the 2026 general election	Not held	Observer missions to the 13 August 2026 general election recorded a hybrid digital and manual voter-registration system with an online pre-registration portal, logging 8,786,300 registered voters, up 25% since 2021; a domestic coalition found election-day process largely transparent but flagged an online-only accreditation system that blocked 11 accredited monitors and the electoral commission's refusal to share the voters register; the European mission found online free expression unduly curtailed under the 2025 Cyber Security Act amid arrests for speech offences, and a regional media institute recorded a journalist detained for two weeks under the Cyber Crimes Act and judged the access-to-information law and decriminalised defamation paper victories undermined by the two 2025 statutes	BASELINE NOT HELD
Human Rights Commission election-period cases	Baseline not held	The Commission's chairperson said its case review meeting considered 105 alleged human rights violations and abuses linked to the election period, of which 62 were resolved through mediation, engagement with responsible institutions, referral for legal assistance, corrective measures and other redress; duty-bearers implicated included law enforcement agencies and justice-sector institutions	BASELINE NOT HELD
ZICTA consent judgment on internet access interruption	No position held on internet-shutdown constraints in Zambia at 2025-08-01	In force on the coalition's account: the regulator undertook not to act outside its authority to interrupt access and to state the reason for any future interruption within 36 hours, after civil society challenged the August 2021 blocking of four platforms; the technology ministry has committed not to shut down the internet at the 13 August 2026 election, and the government has said it could not establish the cause of the 2021 shutdown. No judgment date, cause number or enforcement instance is held	BASELINE NOT HELD

Zimbabwe

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-25	MOVEMENT
Public consultation record for the National AI Strategy	None published	The strategy's own consultation record — a Kadoma draft, then validation at Harare on 2025-08-28, Bulawayo on 2025-09-09 and Masvingo on 2025-09-11; no submission register, participant list or consultation report is held	ADVANCED

West Africa

BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM	AT 2025-08-01	AT 2026-08-27	MOVEMENT
Regional Feminist Data Agenda 2026-2028	Did not exist	Ratified with three priorities for 2026-2028, each carrying a named owner, alongside eight thematic policy briefs and a cross-border encrypted data collective with rapid-response protocols; no text is published	ADVANCED

ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

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Figures are dated because most are time-varying: a figure carries the date it was true, not the date you are reading it. Where the base holds no reliable statement, the document says **Not held** rather than leaving a silence — those are counted, and listed at the end.

This is a dated edition and is not revised after publication. If a figure here has moved, the current edition will say so.